Notice of Public Meeting

Humboldt County Local Emergency Planning Committee Quarterly Meeting
Thursday, January 23, 2025
3:00 PM

Humboldt General Hospital - Sarah Winnemucca Roon
118 Haskell St., Winnemucca, NV 89445

This meeting is the regular quarterly meeting.
We will also conduct a hazmat tabletop exercise.

CALL TO ORDER

PUBLIC COMMENT - (Non-Action Item) - General Public comment is designated for discussion only. The public has the opportunity to address the Committee on any matter not appearing on this agenda; however, no action may be taken on a matter raised until the matter itself has been specifically included on the agenda as an item upon which action may be taken. All public comment may be limited to three (3) minutes.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS

Next Meeting: April 24, 2025
Time: 3:00pm
Location: Winnemucca Fire Station

Suggested agenda items:
OPTE and UWS grant opportunities
Hazmat Team build

TABLETOP EXERCISE

Hazmat tabletop situation manual - scenario will be introduced at the exercise.
Situation-manual - scenario deleted.pdf

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CERTIFICATE OF POSTING

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PLACES POSTED:	Humboldt Co. Courthouse: Room 201	at _3:00 P.M.	By Carol Lynn
	Humboldt General Hospital: 118 E. Haskell	at _3:00 P.M.	By Carol Lynn
	Humboldt County Website: www.hcnv.us	at _3:00 P.M.	By Carol Lynn
	State of Nevada Website: https://notice.nv.us	at _3:00 P.M.	By: Carol Lynn

MEETING DATE: Friday, Jan. 23, 2025 POSTED BY: Carol Lynn

DATE POSTED: Wednesday, Jan. 13, 2025

NOTE FOR SUPPORTING MATERIAL: A copy of the supporting material for the meeting may be obtained at the Humboldt County Manager's Office at 50 W. Fifth Street, Winnemucca, NV 89445. (775) 623-6300.

NOTICE TO PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES: Reasonable efforts will be made to assist and accommodate physically disabled persons desiring to attend this meeting. Please call the Humboldt County Administrator's Office at (775) 623-6300 in advance so that arrangements may be conveniently made.

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY NOTICE: Humboldt County is an Equal Opportunity Employer and will not discriminate against employees or applicants for employment or services in an unlawful manner.

NON-DISCRIMINATION STATEMENT: In accordance with Federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulations and policies; the USDA; its Agencies; offices, and employees, and institutions participating in or administering USDA programs are prohibited from discriminating based on race, color, national origin, religion, sex, gender identity (including gender expression), sexual orientation, disability, age, marital status, family/parental status, income derived from a public assistance program, political beliefs, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity, in any program or activity conducted or funded by USAD (not all bases apply to all programs). Remedies and complaint filing deadlines vary by program or incident.

Humboldt County Local Emergency Planning Committee Agenda Item Report

Meeting Date: January 23, 2025

Submitted by: Carol Lynn

Submitting Department:

Item Type: Staff Report

Agenda Section: FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS

Subject:
Next Meeting: April 24, 2025
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Suggested agenda items:
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Suggested Action:

Humboldt County Local Emergency Planning Committee Agenda Item Report

Meeting Date: January 23, 2025

Submitted by: Carol Lynn

Submitting Department:

Item Type: Staff Report

Agenda Section: TABLETOP EXERCISE

Subject:
Hazmat tabletop situation manual - scenario will be introduced at the exercise.

Suggested Action:

Attachments:
Situation-manual - scenario deleted.pdf

Humboldt County LEPC Tabletop Exercise (TTX)

Situation Manual

January 23, 2025

This Situation Manual (SitMan) provides exercise participants with all the necessary tools for their roles in the exercise. Some exercise material is intended for the exclusive use of exercise planners, facilitators, and evaluators, but players may view other materials that are necessary to their performance. All exercise participants may view the SitMan.

Preface

Exercises are a critical component in the emergency management process to identify strengths and areas for improvement to achieve a greater level of collective preparedness.

This Situation Manual (SitMan) provides exercise participants with all the necessary tools for their roles in the exercise. All exercise participants may view the SitMan. However, some exercise material should not be provided to exercise players because it is intended for the exclusive use of exercise planners, facilitators, and evaluators. Such material should be presented under separate cover (i.e., as part of the Facilitator and Evaluator Handbook).

Special Handling Instructions

While the outline for this exercise is available to the public, if Exercise Design Teams (EDTs) choose to customize the exercise with local information, they may decide to designate the materials as For Official Use Only (FOUO) to designate its contents as sensitive information not to be disclosed to unauthorized personnel.

The control of exercise information is based on sensitivity regarding the nature of the exercise (e.g., the exercise scenario may address politically sensitive issues and/or may portray detailed response plans and potential response shortcomings), rather than the actual exercise content.

If deemed FOUO by the EDT, all exercise participants should follow appropriate guidelines to ensure proper control of information within their areas and safeguard, handle, transmit, and store this material in accordance with current information security policies and directives.

Reproduction of the sensitive information, in whole or in part, is prohibited without prior approval from Humboldt County Emergency Management. At a minimum, this document will be provided on a need-to-know basis only.

EXERCISE OVERVIEW

Exercise Name	Humboldt County LEPC Hazmat Tabletop Exercise (TTX)
Exercise Dates	January 23, 2025
Scope	This exercise is a discussion-based exercise, planned for 3 hours at Humboldt General Hospital. Exercise play is limited to the scenarios set forth in this Situation Manual (SitMan).
Mission Area(s)	Response and Recovery
Core Capabilities	• Information Sharing • Operational Coordination • Public and Private Services and Resources • Situational Assessment
Objectives	• Explore ability to effectively communicate between organizations; • Identify resources and their capabilities available in the area (Government and private); • Identify individual company/agency strengths and weaknesses when responding to emergencies; • Assess the ability to effectively establish and maintain a unified and coordinated operational structure that integrates critical whole community partners in planning and implementation of response and recovery actions.
Threat or Hazard	Hazardous Material spill
Scenario	The Tabletop Exercise discussion will be centered around a railway incident with a hazardous material release scenario that occurs near a populated area. The material release causes significant impact and threat to citizens, water supply, and throughout the immediate the area, residential areas, and businesses.
Sponsor	Humboldt County Emergency Management
Participating Organizations	See Appendix B
Point of Contact	Carol Lynn: carol.lynn@humboldtcountynv.gov(775)375-3195

GENERAL INFORMATION

Exercise Objectives and Core Capabilities

The following exercise objectives in Table 1 describe the expected outcomes for the exercise. The objectives are linked to core capabilities, which are distinct critical elements necessary to achieve the specific mission area(s). The objectives and aligned core capabilities are guided by elected and appointed officials and selected by the Exercise Planning Team.

Exercise Objective	Core Capability
Explore ability to effectively communicate between organizations	Planning
Identify resources and their capabilities available in the area (Government and private)	Planning
Identify individual company/agency strengths and weaknesses when responding to emergencies	Planning
Assess the ability to effectively establish and maintain a unified and coordinated operational structure that integrates critical whole community partners in planning and implementation of response and recovery actions.	Response

Table 1. Exercise Objectives and Associated Core Capabilities

Participant Roles and Responsibilities

The term *participant* encompasses many groups of people, not just those playing in the exercise. Groups of participants involved in the exercise, and their respective roles and responsibilities, are as follows:

- **Players.** Players are personnel who have an active role in discussing or performing their regular roles and responsibilities during the exercise. Players discuss or initiate actions in response to the simulated emergency.
- **Observers.** Observers do not directly participate in the exercise. However, they may support the development of player responses to the situation during the discussion by asking relevant questions or providing subject matter expertise.
- **Facilitators.** Facilitators provide situation updates and moderate discussions. They also provide additional information or resolve questions as required. Key Exercise Planning Team members also may assist with facilitation as subject matter experts (SMEs) during the exercise.
- **Evaluators.** Evaluators are assigned to observe and document certain objectives during the exercise. Their primary role is to document player discussions, including how and if those discussions conform to plans, polices, and procedures.

Exercise Structure

This exercise will be a multimedia, facilitated exercise. Players will participate in the following three modules:

- Module 1: Initial Response – Scenario Background
- Module 2: Response – City area
- Module 3: Review

Each module begins with an update that summarizes key events occurring within that time period. After the updates, participants review the situation and engage in functional group discussions of appropriate response issues. For this exercise, the functional groups are as follows:

- Private Companies
- Response Agencies
- Local Government

After these functional group discussions, participants will engage in a moderated open discussion in which a spokesperson from each group will present a synopsis of the group's actions, based on the scenario.

Exercise Guidelines

- This exercise will be held in an open, low-stress, no-fault environment. Varying viewpoints, even disagreements, are expected.
- Respond to the scenario using your knowledge of current plans and capabilities (i.e., you may use only existing assets) and insights derived from your training.
- Decisions are not precedent setting and may not reflect your organization's final position on a given issue. This exercise is an opportunity to discuss and present multiple options and possible solutions.
- Issue identification is not as valuable as suggestions and recommended actions that could improve response efforts. Problem-solving efforts should be the focus.

Exercise Assumptions and Artificialities

In any exercise, assumptions and artificialities may be necessary to complete play in the time allotted and/or account for logistical limitations. Exercise participants should accept that assumptions and artificialities are inherent in any exercise and should not allow these considerations to negatively impact their participation. During this exercise, the following apply:

- The exercise is conducted in a no-fault learning environment wherein capabilities, plans, systems, and processes will be evaluated.
- The exercise scenario is plausible, and events occur as they are presented.
- All players receive information at the same time.

Exercise Evaluation

Evaluation of the exercise is based on the exercise objectives and aligned capabilities, capability targets, and critical tasks, which are documented in Exercise Evaluation Guides (EEGs). Evaluators have EEGs for each of their assigned areas. Additionally, players will be asked to complete participant feedback forms. These documents, coupled with facilitator observations and notes, will be used to evaluate the exercise and compile the After-Action Report (AAR).

The following questions are provided as suggested subjects that you may wish to address as the discussion progresses. These questions are not meant to constitute a definitive list of concerns to be addressed, nor is there a requirement to address every question.

Private Companies

1. Does your organization have an emergency preparedness plan to address a hazmat incident? Discuss the plan and components. Identify incident roles and responsibilities.
2. What are your site's concerns and priorities?
3. What should your personnel be doing in the event of a hazmat incident?
4. What capabilities do you have to treat injured people?
5. Does your Emergency Response Plan provide information regarding evacuation, shutdown procedures, assembly point, and personnel accountability?

Response Agencies

1. What are your response priorities and incident objectives at this point?
2. Do you have the staff and resources available to respond 24 hours per day for the next 120 hours? If not, where will you look to in obtaining these resources?
3. What agencies, organizations, and other community partners will you engage in the planning process immediately following the derailment? How are you communicating with them?
4. Given the immediate shortages of resources and personnel, how will the use of resources be prioritized and managed to maximize response effectiveness? How will these decisions be made?
5. What is your public information strategy at this point? What methods or means are you using to provide credible and accurate information, and what are you doing to ensure vulnerable populations are reached? Do you have plans in place to use and monitor social media networks?

Local Government

1. What are your response priorities and incident objectives at this point?
2. Do you have a Continuity of Operations Plan (COOP)? What would your first actions include?
3. What agencies, organizations, and other community partners will you engage in the planning process immediately following the earthquake? How are you communicating with them?

Key Issues

- Reported injuries throughout the city;
- Crowd control
- ?

Questions

Based on the information provided, participate in the discussion concerning the issues raised in Module 2. **Identify any critical issues, decisions, requirements, or questions that should be addressed at this time.**

The following questions are provided as suggested subjects that you may wish to address as the discussion progresses. These questions are not meant to constitute a definitive list of concerns to be addressed, nor is there a requirement to address every question.

Private Companies

1. What are some of the other emergencies that would as a result of this hazardous materials containment?
2. How would different companies communicate with each other?
3. What resources and equipment does each company have to address the response efforts?
    a. Clearing of transportation routes?
4. How will your company account for all personnel? Individual response members?
5. What training does your response team have that can help the situation?
6. How would your company communicate with the fire department and establish who needs help the most?
7. Where will command and staging area(s) be established?
8. How will your companies manage non-essential personnel (managers, other operators, etc.)?
9. How would weather affect responses and injuries?

Response Agencies

1. What resources would be dispatched to this incident? What information would be important to know to ensure the necessary resources are dispatched?
2. What information would be important to know enroute to the scene? Are there radio channels or other means of communication we can use to communicate with incoming units?
3. From initial notification, how long will it take to arrive on-scene?
4. What are your major concerns/initial actions arriving on-scene?

5. Who would be the initial Incident Commander and how would they be identified?
6. How would the command post location be shared with other participants in the Unified Command? Who would be a part of the Unified Command?
7. What do you expect the company response teams to accomplish before you arrive on- scene?
8. What resources would you ask of a company for assistance outside of facility?

Local Government

1. How would you communicate with neighboring counties?
2. Have your priorities changed with the new events?
3. What resources and equipment does the City/County have to address the response efforts?
4. How can you support both the response efforts and the recovery actions?

MODULE 3: REVIEW

September 28, 2023

Facilitator will solicit input from each participating member

Strengths

- Each participant will identify at least one "strength" witnessed during the exercise.

Areas for Improvement

- Each participant will identify at least one "area for improvement".

APPENDIX A: EXERCISE SCHEDULE

Time	Activity
October 23rd , 2023	
0830	Registration
0900	Welcome and Opening Remarks and Introductions
0915	Exercise Guidelines and Overview
0930	Module 1: Initial Response – Scenario Background
1015	Break
1030	Module 2: Response – Apex
1115	Break
1130	Review
1150	Closing Comments

APPENDIX B: EXERCISE PARTICIPANTS

Participating Organizations	
Private Company	
Response Agencies	
City of Winnemucca Police	NV Dept of Transportation
Humboldt County Sheriff	NV Energy
Humboldt General Hospital	NV Dept of Emergency Management
Humboldt General EMS	Public Works – City and County
City of Winnemucca Fire Dept.	Harney Electric
Humboldt Rural Fire Dept.	
Golconda Fire District	
Paradise Valley Fire District	
Valmy Fire District	
Orovada Fire District	
Pueblo Fire District	
Local Government	
Humboldt County Manager	
City of Winnemucca Manager	
Humboldt County Commissioners	
City of Winnemucca Council	
Historical Resource Commission	

APPENDIX C: ACRONYMS

Acronym	Definition
AAR/IP	After Action Report/Improvement Plan
DHS	U.S. Department of Homeland Security
EAP	Emergency Action Plan
EMS	Emergency Medical Service
EOC	Emergency Operations Center
FEMA	Federal Emergency Management Agency
HazMat	Hazardous Materials
HSEEP	Homeland Security Exercise and Evaluation Program
IP	DHS NPPD Office of Infrastructure Protection
MMS	Moment Magnitude Scale
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
Mw	See MMS
N/A	Not Applicable

APPENDIX D: PARTICIPANT FEEDBACK FORM

Participant Feedback Form

Thank you for participating in this exercise. Your observations, comments, and input are greatly appreciated, and provide invaluable insight that will better prepare our community against threats and hazards. Any comments provided will be treated in a sensitive manner and all personal information will remain confidential. Please keep comments concise, specific, and constructive.

General Information

Please enter your responses in the form field or check box after the appropriate selection.

Name: _____

Agency/Organization Affiliation: _____

Position Title: _____

Years of Experience in Present Position: _____

Exercise Role: ☐ Player ☐ Facilitator ☐ Observer ☐ Evaluator

Number of Exercises Previously Participated in: 0☐ 1-5☐ 5-10☐ 15+☐

Exercise Design

Please rate, on a scale of 1 to 5, your overall assessment of the exercise relative to the statements provided, with 1 indicating strong disagreement and 5 indicating strong agreement.

Assessment Factor	Strongly Disagree				Strongly Agree
Pre-exercise briefings were informative and provided the necessary information for my role in the exercise.	1	2	3	4	5
The exercise scenario was plausible and realistic.	1	2	3	4	5
Exercise participants included the right people in terms of level of seniority or experience and mix of disciplines.	1	2	3	4	5
Participants were actively involved in the exercise.	1	2	3	4	5
Exercise participation was appropriate for someone in my field with my level of experience/training.	1	2	3	4	5
The exercise increased my understanding about, and familiarity with, the capabilities and resources of other participating organizations.	1	2	3	4	5
The exercise provided the opportunity to address significant decisions in support of critical mission areas.	1	2	3	4	5
After this exercise, I am better prepared to deal with the capabilities and hazards addressed.	1	2	3	4	5

1. **What specific training opportunities helped you (or could have helped you) prepare for this exercise? Please provide specific course names if applicable.**

Training	Completed Prior to Exercise? (Y/N)

2. **Which exercise materials were most useful? Please identify any additional materials or resources that would be useful for future exercises.**

3. **Please provide any recommendations on how this exercise or future exercises could be improved or enhanced.**